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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (Honours) Special
Examinations, July 2026 (for 2024 Admission Regular Examinations, October 2025)
Third SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCENG202 – DETECTIVE FICTION

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum marks: 70**

Scheme of Valuation

Part A - MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. d). To prove his client is innocent [K] / [CO1]
2. b). By substituting the letter with another one [U] / [CO2]
3. a). They were drunk and wore masks [K] / [CO3]
4. c). Paddy field [K] / [CO3]
5. a). To ensure fairness to the reader [An /[CO1]
6. b). Hidden in plain sight [K] / [CO2]
7. a). Yiddische Zeitung [K] / [CO3]
8. d). 1930s [U] / [CO3]
9. b). A corpse [K] / [CO1]
10. d). To contrast his habits with others in the town [U] / [CO2]

[1x10 = 10]

Part B - SHORT ANSWER
Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 Marks

11. Murder on the Orient Express-Christie problematizes certain concepts of morality and justice-raises the question whether the legal system of the state is sufficient to do justice to the people-sermonises on private justice and ethics of revenge-Poirot functions as a moral arbiter-reflects upper-middle-class values, occasionally departing from strict humanistic ethics. [An]/[CO3]

12. Sherlock’s reliance on technology that affects the traditional detective methods: Sherlock uses technology such as smartphones, GPS, text messages, computer databases, and internet searches to gather information quickly-These tools help him access evidence and communicate efficiently during investigations. [U] / [CO3]

13. Auden considers Chandler's approach misguided because it emphasizes violence and the criminal underworld instead of the detective story's true purpose of restoring justice, moral order, and intellectual satisfaction [U] / [CO1]

14. The final confrontation reveals Holmes's extraordinary courage, selflessness, and commitment to justice-chooses tom face Professor Moriarty alone to protect society- willingness to sacrifice his own life – a man with moral integrity, fearlessness and dedication to defeat evil [U] / [CO2]

15. symbolic significance of the “labyrinth made of a single straight line” mentioned at the end of "Death and the Compass": Throughout the story, Detective Erik Lönnrot expects a complex, mysterious labyrinth of clues- Instead, Scharlach creates a simple and direct path that leads Lönnrot to his own death- Thus, the "single straight line" is a labyrinth because there is only one possible path,

with no escape-Lönnrot relies too much on logic, symbols, and patterns-He ignores simpler explanations and walks directly into Scharlach's plan. [E] / [CO3]

16. The dynamics between Sherlock Holmes and Dr. John Watson in “A Study in Pink”: Holmes is the brilliant detective, while Watson is his loyal friend, companion, and narrator-Watson deeply admires Holmes's intelligence, especially his powers of observation and deduction-Although Holmes is emotionally reserved, he trusts Watson more than anyone else and often allows him to accompany him on investigations-Watson acts as the bridge between Holmes and the readers. Since Holmes's methods are too complex to understand immediately, Watson narrates the stories from an ordinary person's perspective, making the mysteries engaging-Holmes appreciates Watson's companionship. Even though Watson cannot match Holmes's analytical skills, his kindness, courage, and practical support are invaluable-Their relationship is built on mutual respect, loyalty, and friendship rather than equality in detective skills-Watson also provides a human perspective, balancing Holmes's cold logic with empathy and emotion. [U] / [CO3]

17. Freeman compares sensationalism to drugs or stimulants as both create a tolerance which has to be met by an increase of the dose- readers accustomed to sensational stories require more shocking incidents and thrilling climaxes to remain excited- the writers then pile up incident on incident, climax on climax [U] / [CO1]

18. Kailash Chowdhury's Jewel is a thrilling detective story by Satyajit Ray, featuring his iconic sleuth, Pradosh C Mitter, popularly known as Feluda. The story begins with Feluda being approached by Kailash Chowdhury, a former zamindar and renowned shikari, who seeks his help after receiving a threatening letter demanding the return of a mysterious jewel. Feluda carefully analyses the threatening note, questions everyone connected with the blue beryl, and observes their behaviour-With his sharp intellect, keen observation, and calm demeanour, Feluda unravels the mystery, exposes the true culprit- uses logical deduction rather than guesswork- The story is a testament to Ray's mastery of suspense and his ability to craft engaging narratives filled with wit, intrigue, and memorable characters. [U] / [CO2]

19. The significance of Poirot's choice to leave the final decision to M. Bouc and Dr. Constantine: The story revolves around the famous fictional detective Hercule Poirot who investigates a murder that occurs on the luxurious Orient Express train during its journey from Istanbul to Calais- American tycoon, Ratchett who is revealed to be Casetti, lies dead in his compartment, stabbed- Poirot’s investigation reveals that all the twelve members of the Armstrong family stabbed Ratchett-difficult to make out who actually dealt the fatal stab-instead of taking them to the law, Poirot creates a story to acquit the twelve passengers-suggests two possible solutions of the crime and leave the final decision to M. Bouc and Dr. Constantine, two fellow passengers on the train to judge which solution is the right one. [An] / [CO3]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C - ESSAY
Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. Hercule Poirot’s actions in Murder on the Orient Express challenge traditional expectations of the detective figure within the detective fiction genre- Hercule Poirot investigates a murder that occurs on the luxurious Orient Express train during its journey from Istanbul to Calais- American tycoon, Ratchett who is revealed to be Casetti, lies dead in his compartment, stabbed- Poirot’s investigation reveals that all the twelve members of the Armstrong family stabbed Ratchett -instead of taking them to the law, Poirot creates a story to acquit the twelve passengers-Christie’s personal faith in the canon

of Christianity is revealed here-Poirot justifies the murder and suggests divine retribution instead of social justice to the murderers-Poirot allows the murderers to extract vengeance on their on their nemesis. [An]/[CO3]

21. Freeman's essay " The Art of Detective Story"- outlines his views on the structure and elements of a good detective story-argues that a detective story should not only entertain but also challenge the intellect of its readers- the distinctive quality that sets it apart from all other types of fiction is the intellectual satisfaction that it offers- Though it should possess qualities required for other good fiction-grace of diction, humour, interesting characterization, picturesqueness of setting, emotional presentation-in detective fiction they are secondary and subordinate to intellectual satisfaction that it provides [E] / [CO1]

22. Sir Arthur Conan Doyle builds up suspense and tension in the opening part of "The Final Problem" using a series of carefully arranged narrative techniques- Dr. Watson begins by saying that he has long hesitated to write about this particular case-this creates immediate curiosity-Holmes' unexpected arrival at Watson's house looking pale and anxious- revelation about the repeated attempts on his life-Doyle introduces the mysterious Professor Moriarty-an atmosphere of tension, danger and urgency pervades the opening part [An] / [CO2]

23. Noah Cross embodies the theme of absolute power and corruption in *Chinatown*- The film displays the deep-rooted corruption in society, socio-economic, political and psychological consequences it causes in a people- Noah Cross represents the corrupting influence of power-a wealthy, influential businessman -manipulates the city's water supply as well as his own family to achieve his goals-uses his unchecked power for his own selfish gains. [An] / [CO3]

[15x2 = 30]